GOVERNANCE FOR AUTOMATED BUSINESS DECISIONS

AEGIS

Software proposes. People set the rules. Aegis keeps both honest.

Competition booklet · October 2026

Built in Progress OpenEdge ABL

START HERE

Aegis in 30 seconds

More and more businesses let software decide things: a price, a shift, an order. Aegis makes sure each decision follows rules your people wrote, is written down for good, and can explain itself.

What it is

A rulebook, a referee and a record book for automated decisions.

Who it is for

Any business that lets software decide, and needs to answer “who allowed that, and why?”

What it is not

Not another calculator. Aegis does not do the maths, and its AI never decides. It governs whoever does.

In plain English: the referee

A fast player needs someone holding the rulebook.

1. **The robot calculates**

   Quick and tireless. It knows its numbers, not your rules. Example: it wants to raise a price by 40%.

2. **Aegis holds the rulebook**

   Rule PR-1 says no rise above 10% in Normal times. The request is denied, and the denial is written in a book nobody can erase.

3. **People can override**

   A manager says “holiday weekend, this time it is fine.” The override is recorded as its own entry, so the trail stays complete.

Later: the Ombudsman AI ROADMAP

It would watch the overrides and learn when the same one keeps happening, so rules do not get stuck in the past. Not built yet.

THE PROBLEM

Automation without a referee

Three things go wrong when software acts on its own. Each one has a direct answer in Aegis.

The Black Box

A change happens and nobody can say who allowed it, or why.

Answer: the Charter. Every rule is written down, with a name and a limit.

The Accountability Gap

An auditor asks for the record, and there is no permanent trail.

Answer: the sealed Warrant. Each decision is recorded all or nothing, and cannot be edited.

The Rogue Engine

An AI chases one number with no human context.

Answer: an AI that only explains. It writes after the ruling, and every number it uses is checked.

The idea in one line. Engines propose. The Steward judges them against the Charter. The Seal records a Warrant that cannot be edited. The Advocate explains the result in plain words, with every number checked first.

Why a referee, and not a better robot

A better robot still cannot show its permission. Aegis separates the three jobs that automation usually mixes together: **calculating** (the engine), **judging** (the Steward and the Charter) and **remembering** (the Warrant ledger). Because they are separate, any engine can be replaced, and the rules and the record stay the same.

Rules live in one place

The Charter holds the limits. An engine cannot quietly bypass them, because only the Steward can rule.

The record outlives the engine

If an engine is swapped or retired, its past proposals and Warrants stay on record and can still be replayed.

HOW IT WORKS

Four steps, for every decision

An engine proposes. It cannot act alone. Each step below does one job.

1 **Steward** BUILT AND TESTED

Judges the proposal against the Charter and rules Admit or Deny.

2 **Seal** BUILT AND TESTED

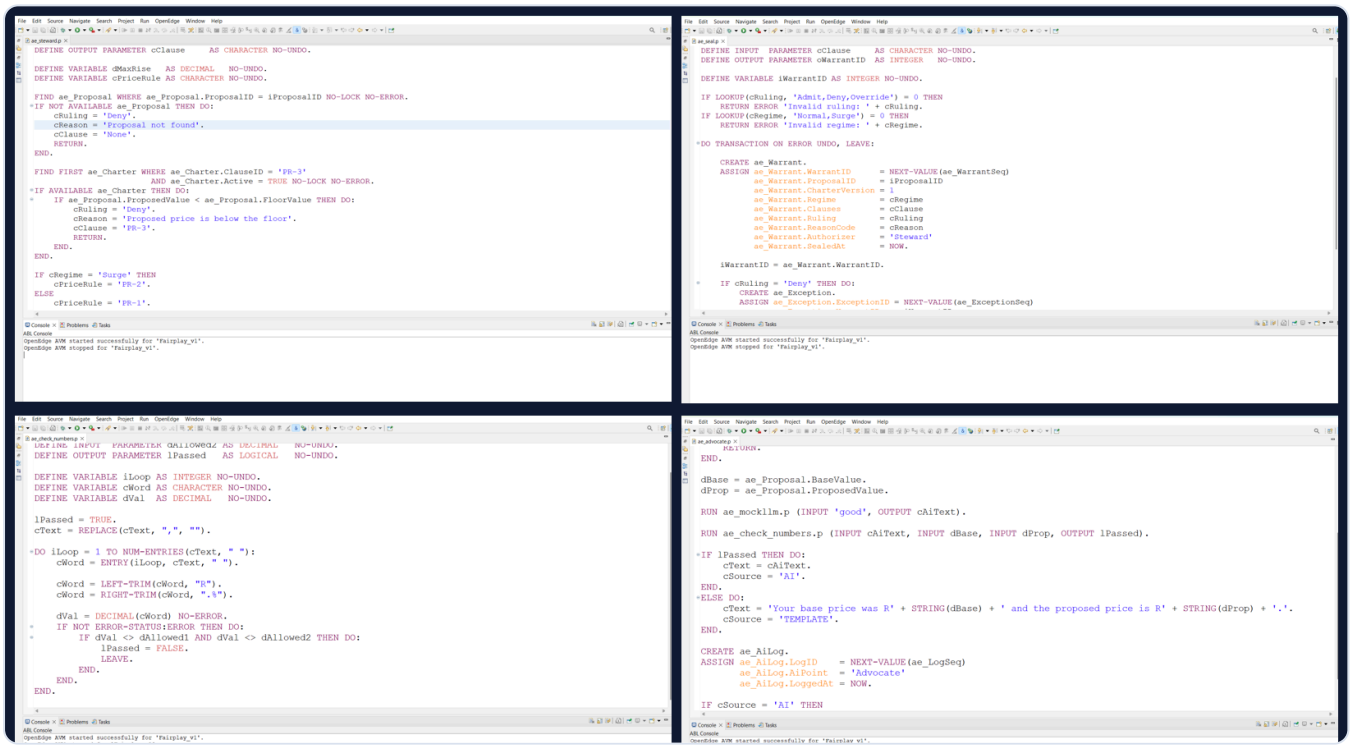
Records a Warrant, all or nothing. A failed write saves nothing. A Warrant cannot be edited or deleted.

3 **Number check** BUILT AND TESTED

Every number the AI writes is compared with the record before anyone sees it.

4 **Advocate** BUILT AND TESTED

Explains the ruling in plain words. If the number check fails, or the AI is unavailable, a fixed template is used instead.



Real capture: the programs behind each step (ae_steward, ae_seal, ae_check_numbers and ae_advocate).

Replay

Any past decision can be re-run from its record, to prove the ruling would be the same today.

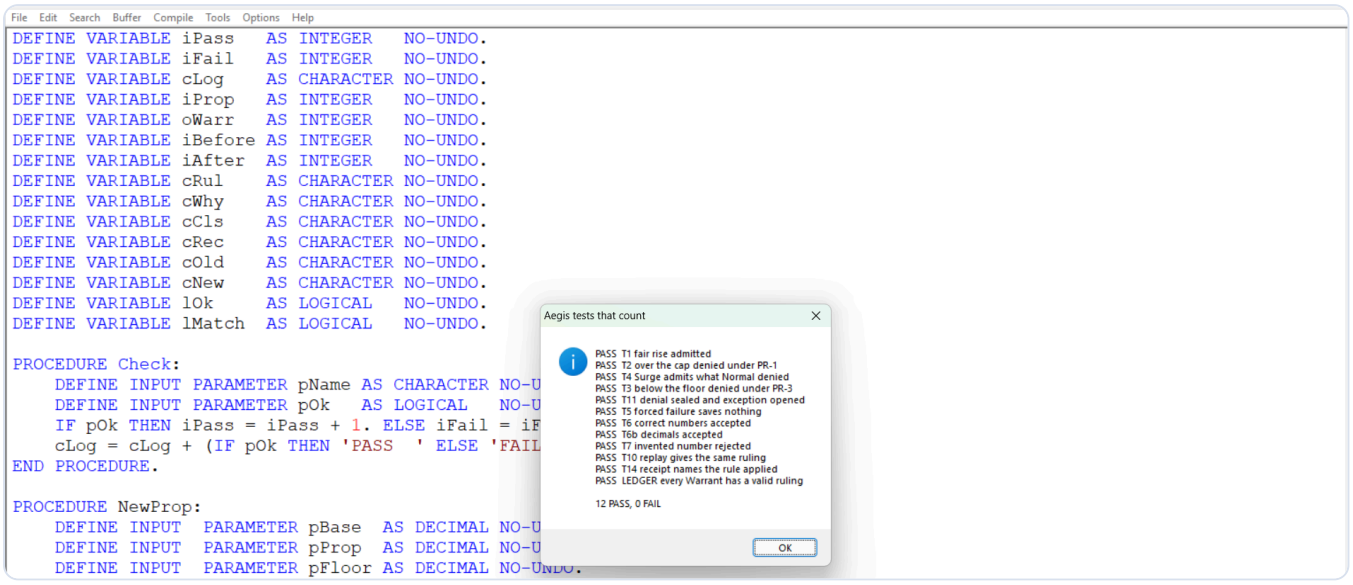
Exceptions

A refusal is not an error. It waits for a person, and what the person decides is recorded too.

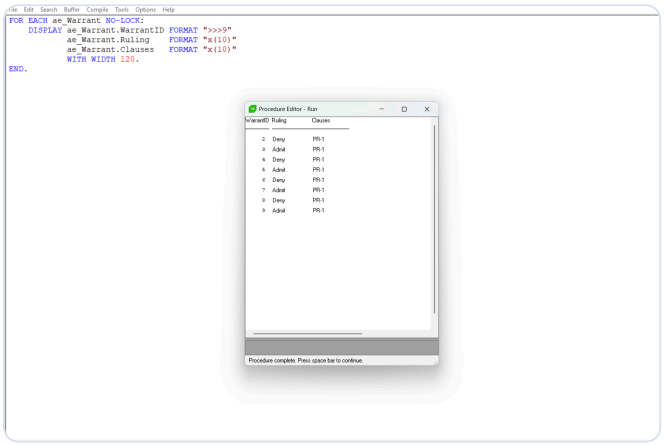
EVIDENCE

Proof, not promises

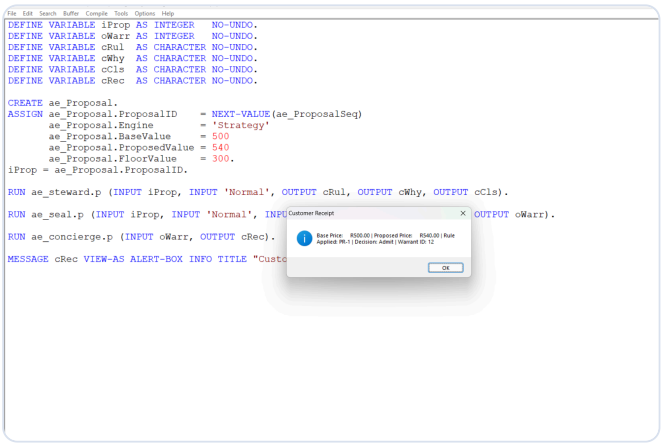
These are captures from the build running on the development machine.



The tests that count, passing. Tests cover the Steward, the Seal, the number check, the Advocate and replay.



The ledger of sealed Warrants. Each row is a decision with its ruling and the rule applied.



The customer receipt. The decision is explained in words, and every number comes from the record.

The Live Simulator

A simulated day runs bookings through the Steward and shows each ruling as it is sealed.

The honest limit

The simulation uses generated data. There are no customers and no revenue claims in this booklet.

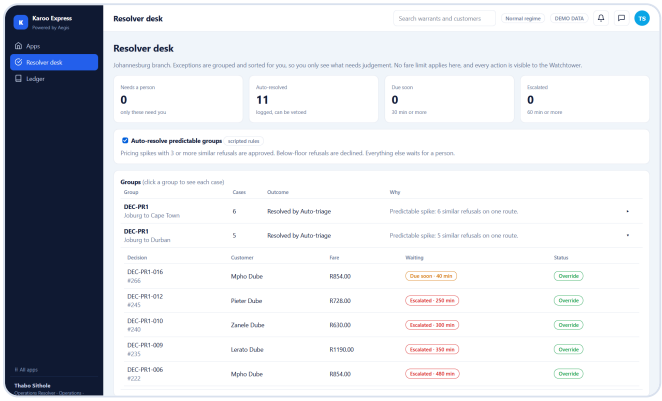
PEOPLE STAY IN CHARGE

A clear chain of authority

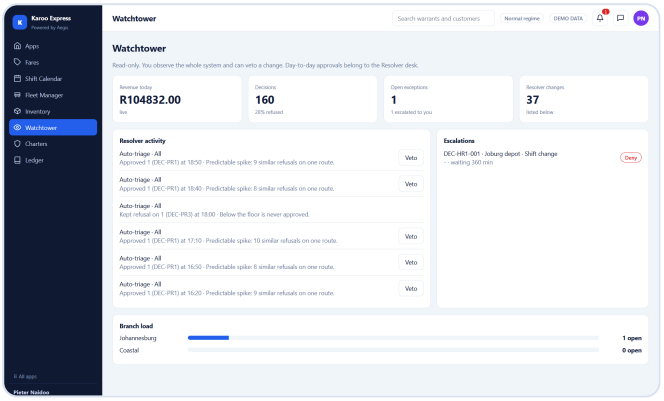
Aegis is not only automation. It decides who may do what, and records it.

LEVEL	WHAT THEY DO
Auto-triage	Groups similar exceptions and clears the predictable ones. Every automatic action is logged.
Resolvers	Clear the remaining exceptions in bulk, inside their own branch.
Managers	Veto a bad batch. A veto creates a Counter-Warrant, so the reversal is recorded.
Owner	Watches the Watchtower and sets global guardrails. Departments set their own limits inside them.

Shown in the platform mockup. CONCEPT Nothing in the platform is written to the OpenEdge ledger.



Concept screen: exceptions grouped for the resolver.



Concept screen: the read-only Watchtower, with veto.

Every role gets its own assistant CONCEPT, SCRIPTED

Each assistant answers only about what its role may see. Anything else becomes an access request that the Steward rules on under rule AC-1, records, and sends to the manager who owns that area. Shifts are shared across departments for viewing, and a change is a request the HR Manager approves.

ASSISTANT	CAN ANSWER ABOUT
Owner Briefing, Manager Concierge	Pricing, shifts, fleet and stock
Resolver Advocate, Counter Concierge, Audit Advocate	Pricing and shifts
HR Concierge	Shifts

HOW IT BECOMES A BUSINESS

One governed core, many engines

Pricing is the first engine, and the one that proves the contract. The same four steps govern any engine that writes a proposal.

AEGIS CORE

Charter · Steward · Seal · Ledger · AI cage

Pricing	Shifts	Fleet and stock	Your engine
BUILT	CONCEPT	CONCEPT	writes a proposal

Designed to be licensed

We build and maintain the governance core. Each business plugs in its own engines.

Where we honestly are

The core and one engine are built and tested. No customers or revenue yet. Next: a shadow-mode pilot with one operator.

What is built, and what is not

ITEM	STATUS
Steward, Seal and Warrant ledger	**Built and tested**
Replay of any decision	**Built and tested**
Advocate: number check and template fallback	**Built and tested**
Pricing engine and multi-asset simulator	**Built and tested**
Live model connection for the Advocate	**Working in testing**
Platform: launcher, Resolver desk, Watchtower, Charters, shared shifts, role assistants	**Concept (browser mockup, scripted)**
Precog, earned autonomy, decision taxonomy, Ombudsman AI	**Roadmap**
HR, demand and integration engines	**Roadmap**

TRY IT YOURSELF

Run the demo

Built and tested on OpenEdge 12.8, Windows. First-time setup is in README-setup.md.

DOUBLE-CLICK	WHAT YOU WILL SEE
tests.bat (first)	The original engine tests
count.bat (second)	One scoreboard for the tests that count
demo.bat	The Live Simulator, fed by a simulated day
present.bat	The app launcher: Live display, Presentation, Platform, Explained and Rules

How to read the labels. Built and tested means it runs in OpenEdge and has tests. Concept means a scripted browser mockup. Roadmap means not built.

The AI is optional. With no key set, or if its answer fails the number check, Aegis falls back to fixed templates, so the demo never depends on a network.

Engines propose.
People decide.
Aegis proves it.